12.2 Adding EF Core to an application

In this section we focus on getting EF Core installed and configured in your ASP.NET Core recipe API app. You'll learn how to install the required NuGet packages and build the data model for your application. As we're talking about EF Core in this chapter, I'm not going to go into how to create the application in general. I created a simple minimal API app as the basis—nothing fancy.

TIP The sample code for this chapter shows the state of the application at three points in this chapter: at the end of section 12.2, at the end of section 12.3, and at the end of the chapter. It also includes examples using both LocalDB and SQLite providers.

Interaction with EF Core in the example app occurs in a service layer that encapsulates all the data access outside your minimal API endpoint handlers, as shown in figure 12.4. This design keeps your concerns separated and makes your services testable.